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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture
(https://doa.gov.lk/)

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நெல் ஆராய்ச்சி அபிவிருத்தி நிறுவனம் - பதலகொட
Rice Research and Development Institute (RRDI) - Bathalagoda

ss : Bathalagoda, Ibbagamuwa, Sri Lanka
l : rrdi@doa.gov.lk(mailto:rrdi@doa.gov.lk)
hone : +94 372 258561
+94 372 259881

(https://www.facebook.com/rrdi.bathalagoda/)

RICE IN SRI LANKA - RICE DISEASES

Sheath Rot

Causative agent

Fungus, *Sarocladium oryzae*.

affects most prevailing rice varieties.

usually minor, affecting scattered tillers in a field.

Occasionally, larger areas of a field may have significant damage.

Plant parts and life stages affected

Uppermost leaf sheaths that enclose the young panicle during the boot stage

Symptoms

Lesions are oblong or irregular oval spots with gray or light-brown centers and a dark reddish-brown, diffuse margin, (a typical irregular target pattern).

Usually expressed as a reddish-brown discoloration of the flag-leaf sheath.

Early or severe infections affect the panicle causing the panicle to emerge partially. The un-emerged portion of the panicle rots, turning florets to red-brown – dark brown.

Grains from damaged panicles are discolored reddish-brown to dark brown and may not fill.

A powdery white growth consisting of spores and hyphae of the pathogen may be observed on the adaxial surface of affected sheaths.

Conditions that favour the disease

(During the period from flowering to fruiting)

Environmental temperatures within 20-28 ^{O}C

High humidity

Excessive use of nitrogen fertilizer

Disease Management

Within the crop season

Application of urea in recommended dosages or application of urea based on leaf colour chart.

If the crop is infected, following management options should be applied for the next season

Application of organic fertilizer to improve soil conditions

Use of certified seed paddy free from the disease

Weed management (../rrdi_riceweeds)

Addition of burnt paddy husk (253 kg per acre) to the soil during land preparation.

Abstain addition of straw infected with disease

Management of insect populations (Sheath mite)

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